

Haley Tolan

Immersive Educational Technology Specialist

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Immersive Educational Technology Specialist with 2.5+ years implementing extended reality (XR) technology into higher education at the University of Michigan. Experienced in coordinating cross-institutional initiatives, advising faculty and partner institutions on XR best practices, and supporting university-wide events. Proven ability to lead teams, mentor junior staff, and manage complex multi-event logistics across a library of 250+ XR devices. Committed to advancing the role of immersive technology in learning environments, with a background in cognitive science and linguistics that informs a human-centered approach to technology adoption and program design.

Professional Experience

Extended Reality (XR) Fellow

2023 - Present

University of Michigan - Center of Academic Innovation

Ann Arbor, MI

Project Manager

- Developed and instituted Work Breakdown Structures (WBS) to define project timelines and priorities, breaking down complex XR initiatives into clear, manageable tasks for efficient execution and delegation.
- Processed and tracked expense reports for equipment purchases and program-related expenditures.
- Oversaw license management and access for platforms including Canvas, Uptale, Sketchfab, and Talespin; including user administration, license tracking, and coordination of HR training support sessions.
- Served as primary liaison between technical and non-technical stakeholders, translating XR workflows and project updates into accessible language for faculty, administrators, and external partners.

Equipment and Events Manager

- Managed a library of approximately 250 XR devices including Meta Quest Pro, Quest 3, and Apple Vision Pro headsets, overseeing the full equipment lifecycle from procurement intake to disposal.
- Sole planner and executor for Behavior Based Interviewing VR training sessions in collaboration with the university HR department; managed all pre-event logistics, device setup, and on-site facilitation.
- Facilitated the seamless integration of XR technology into event operations by advising on best practices, resolving technical issues in real time, and coordinating setup to ensure smooth execution.
- Presented the XR team's developed work at high-profile university events including the Campus 2050 presentation at the University President's residence; served as technical lead for on-site headset support.

Equipment Manager and Consultant

- Authored and revised standard operating procedures (SOPs) for headset selection, preparation, sanitization, storage, and transport; maintained documentation accuracy across device generations (Quest Pro, Quest 3, Apple Vision Pro).
- Participated in stakeholder meetings with external partners as a delegate, providing subject-matter expertise on XR equipment and workflows.
- Trained and supervised two junior XR fellows, developing onboarding materials and providing ongoing mentorship to ensure program continuity during leadership transitions.
- Coordinated device availability across simultaneous multi-event weeks, proactively managing scheduling conflicts to ensure all programs were fully equipped without overlap issues.

Extended Reality (XR) Technology Support

2023 - 2025

University of Michigan - School of Nursing

Ann Arbor, MI

- Served as sole program coordinator for the Big Ten Nursing VR initiative across four semesters, delivering biweekly sessions to 120 students a semester.
- Prepared ~1,200 XR Headsets total over the course of the 4 semesters and provided on-site IT / headset support during all sessions.
- Provided technical consulting, educational resources, and organizational guidance to peer institutions participating in the program across the Big Ten network.
- Supported transitioning of the Big Ten Nursing program at program conclusion, ensuring continuity of documentation and equipment handoff.

Presentations

Innovation Summit: *AI and the Future of Learning*

March 17th, 2026

University of Michigan IT Leadership Conference

October 14th, 2025

CMU Regents' and President's Tailgate

September 13th, 2025

Spark Festival of Learning

March 28th, 2025

University of Michigan President's House: *Campus 2050 on Apple Vision Pro*

February 18th, 2025

Publications

Tolan, Haley. "Breaking Barriers: How Dr. Michelle Aebersold Is Revolutionizing Healthcare Education through AI and Virtual Reality." *Themich.org*, The Mich, 3 Dec. 2025, themich.org/2025/12/03/breaking-barriers/.

Certifications

Coursera: Intro to AR/VR/MR/XR: Technologies, Applications & Issues

Nov 2023

Coursera: User Experience & Interaction Design for AR/VR/MR/XR

Dec 2023

Coursera: Developing AR/VR/MR/XR Apps with WebXR, Unity & Unreal

Dec 2023

Google Project Management

In Progress

Google AI Essentials

In Progress

Education

Master's of Technology Studies, Eastern Michigan University

2026 - 2028

Technology Management

Bachelor's of Cognitive Science, University of Michigan

2022 - 2026

College of Literature, Science, and Arts - Residential College

- Michigan Marching Band - Color Guard (2022 - 2025)
- Residential College - Peer Mentor (2023 - 2025)
- Cognitive Science Club (2023 - 2026)